CLEM AND PLUM

A Day by the Garden, Woods, and Pond

Section 1: Act 1 — In the Garden • Consonant Blends Phonics Coloring Book



Target Blends: cl- (Clem) • pl- (Plum) • cr- (crop) • sp- (spud) • gr- (grub) • sn- (snag)

This Adventure Book Belongs To: _____

ACT 1: IN THE GARDEN — MEET THE CHARACTERS

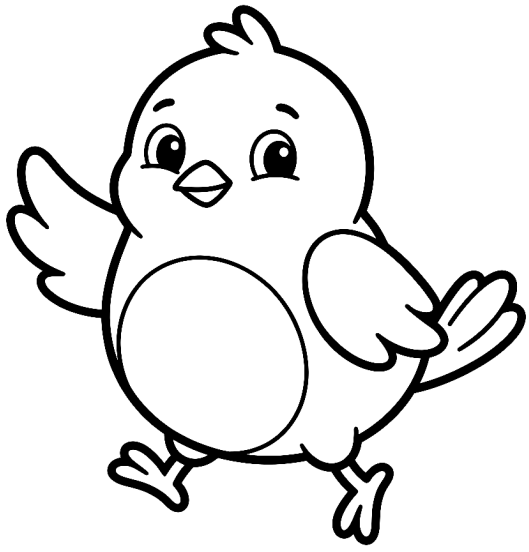
Stage 1: Meet Our Adventure Heroes — Color Clem and Plum!



cl- blend: cl + em = Clem

Meet Clem

"Hi! I am **Clem**. Like all eager and cheerful little 5-year-olds, I am very curious and love to ask questions kids would actually ask! I am the 'doer' kind — one who touches and tries things, and gets a little muddy. Today, **Plum** and I are off on a brand-new adventure. Want to come along? Let's go!"



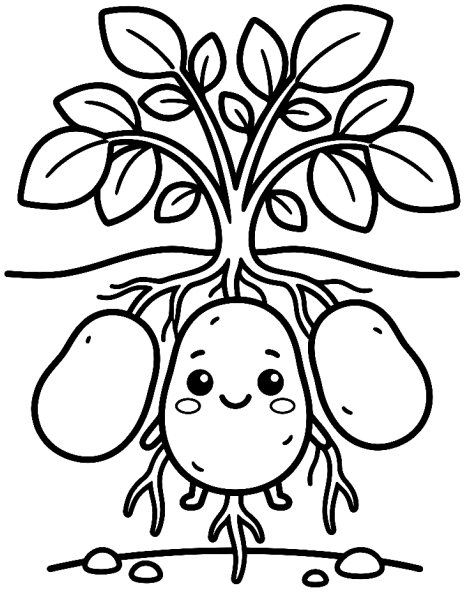
pl- blend: pl + um = Plum

Meet Plum

"Chirp! Meet **Plum** — I am a small, round bluebird and **Clem**'s dear friend! I am very cute, calm, and slightly wiser — a gentle guide rather than a bossy one. I notice special things in nature first and nudge **Clem** toward them!"

ACT 1: IN THE GARDEN — MEET THE CHARACTERS

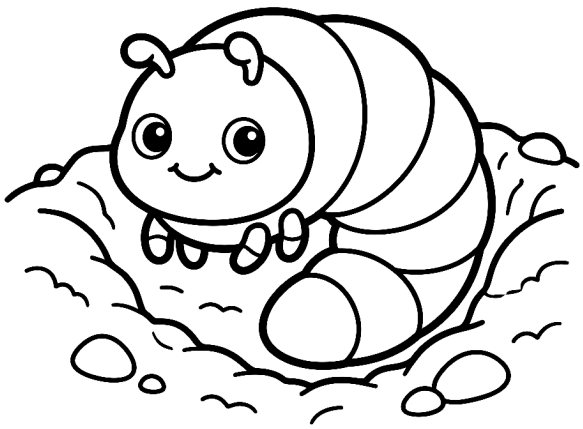
Stage 1: Meet the Garden Pals — Color Mr. Spud and Little Grub!



sp- blend: sp + ud = spud

Meet Mr. Spud

“Hello! I am **Mr. Spud**! ‘**Spud**’ is a silly nickname for a potato — just like calling a dog a pup! I grow underground attached to lush green potato plant roots until gardeners dig me up!”



gr- blend: gr + ub = grub

Meet Little Grub

“Peek-a-boo! I am **Little Grub**! A **grub** is a tiny, squishy baby bug that lives in the garden dirt. I’m a shy baby beetle, and one day I will grow a shell and wings and turn into a big beetle!”

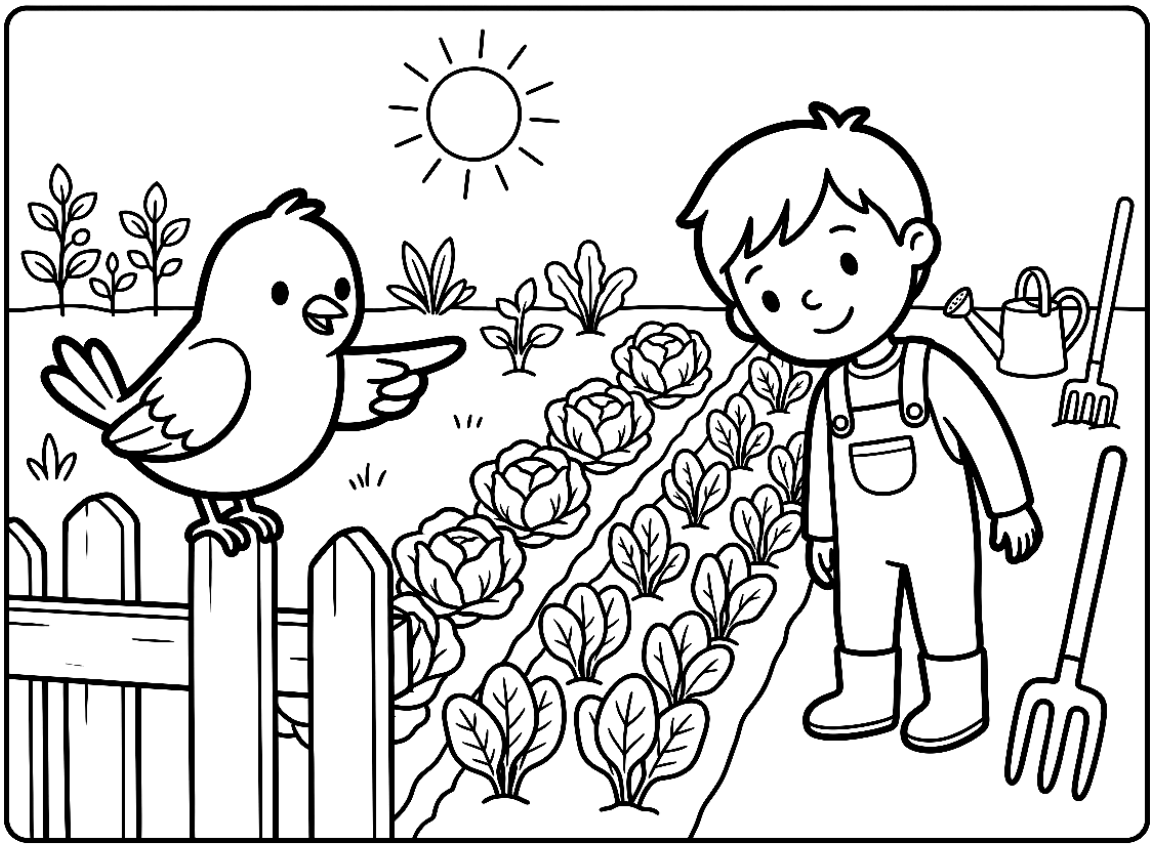
ACT 1, PART 1: THE LEAFY GREEN CROP

Blend Words: cr-op (crop) • Cl-em • Pl-um

Plum and **Clem** were in the garden. **Plum** fluttered down onto the garden fence. Together they walked past rows of green plants, ready to see what had grown this season.

Clem stared at the long, leafy rows and tilted his head. “See all these matching spinach and cabbage plants?” **Plum** asked. “When we grow a whole field of the exact same plant, that big group of plants is called a **crop**! We owe a big thanks to our farmers, **Clem**.”

Plum hopped along the fence. “I like sunflower seeds. What is your favorite food, strawberries or carrots?” **Clem** grinned and shouted, “Strawberries, and mud pies!”

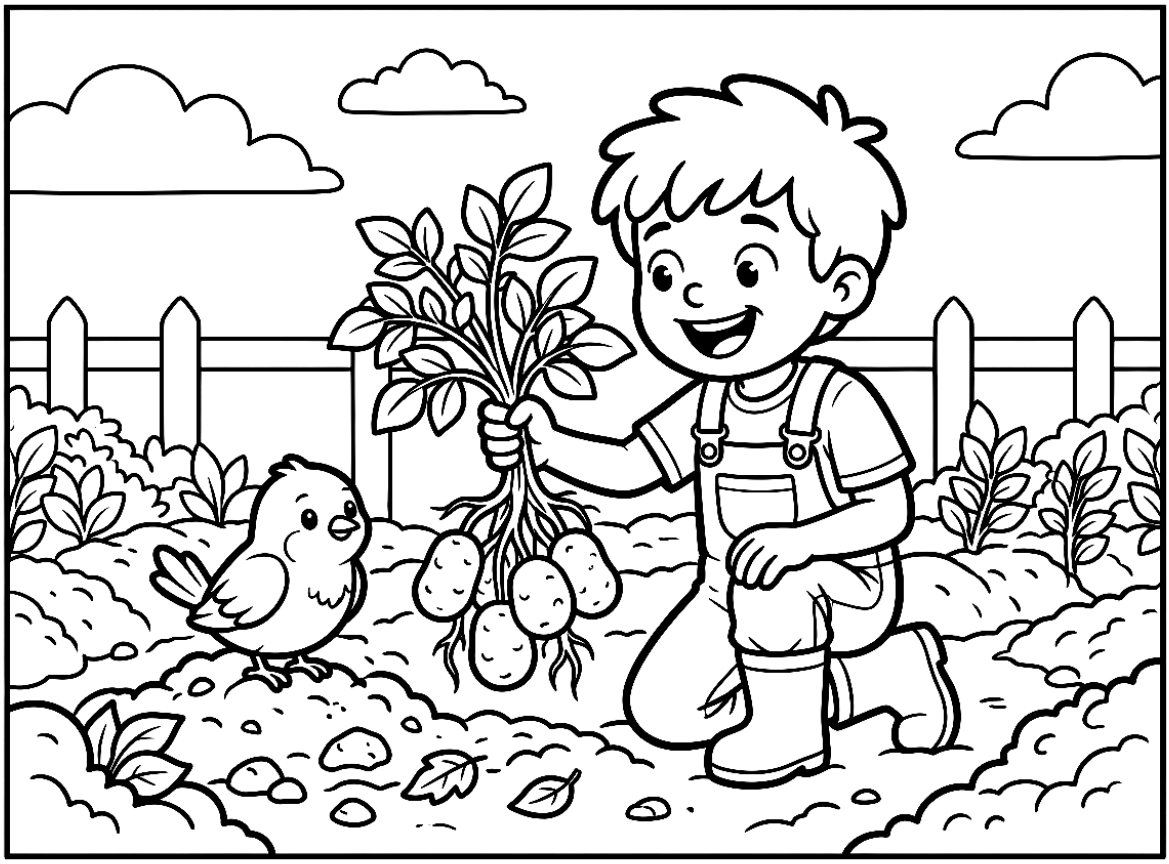


ACT 1, PART 2: HELLO, MR. SPUD!

Blend Words: sp-ud (spud) • Cl-em • Pl-um

Clem and **Plum** walked by the potato patch, where lush green plants swayed in the breeze. **Clem** knelt down and pulled up a whole plant — dusty potatoes dangled from its roots! “Look, I found potatoes!” he shouted. “You found **spuds**!” **Plum** chirped.

“**Spuds**? What’s a **spud**?” **Clem** asked. “**Spud** is a silly nickname for a potato,” **Plum** said, “just like calling a dog a pup! A long time ago, gardeners used a little shovel called a **spud** to dig up treats from the ground, so people started calling potatoes **spuds** too!” **Clem** held up the plant and giggled, “Hello, Mr. **Spud**!”



ACT 1, PART 3: THE SHY LITTLE GRUB

Blend Words: gr-ub (grub) • Cl-em • Pl-um

Plum hopped closer and peeked into the hole where the plant had been. Something wiggled! “A **grub**!” **Plum** said with a giggle. “He’s shy, so say hello gently.” **Clem** leaned in and whispered, “Hello, little **grub**.”

“What’s a **grub**?” **Clem** asked, tilting his head. “A **grub** is a tiny, squishy baby bug that lives in the dirt,” **Plum** explained. “He’s a baby beetle, and one day he will grow a shell and wings and turn into a big beetle!” **Clem**’s eyes grew wide. “See you when you’re big, **grub**!”



ACT 1, PART 4: CAUGHT ON A ROSE BUSH SNAG

Blend Words: sn-ag (snag) • Cl-em • Pl-um

Clem brushed the dirt off his overalls and walked over to a rose bush. He leaned in to smell a rose, but his sleeve caught on a thorny branch. Tug, tug! A little thread pulled out of his white shirt. “Oh no, what happened?” he asked.

“That’s called a **snag**,” **Plum** said. “When a sharp point catches on fabric and pulls a thread, that’s a **snag**.” **Clem** tugged his sleeve free and laughed. “**Snag**!” he said. “Gotcha, you sneaky bush!”



ACT 1 BLEND WORD PRACTICE — SOUND, COLOR & TRACE

Adventure Friends (cl- & pl- Blends) • Say the blend sounds, color the picture, and trace each word!



CL- INITIAL BLEND

CLEM

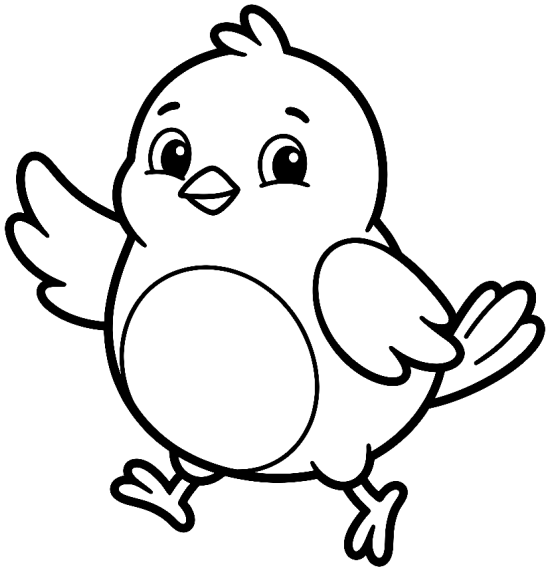
cl + em = clem

1. Trace UPPERCASE:

CLEM

2. Trace lowercase & write:

clem



PL- INITIAL BLEND

PLUM

pl + um = plum

1. Trace UPPERCASE:

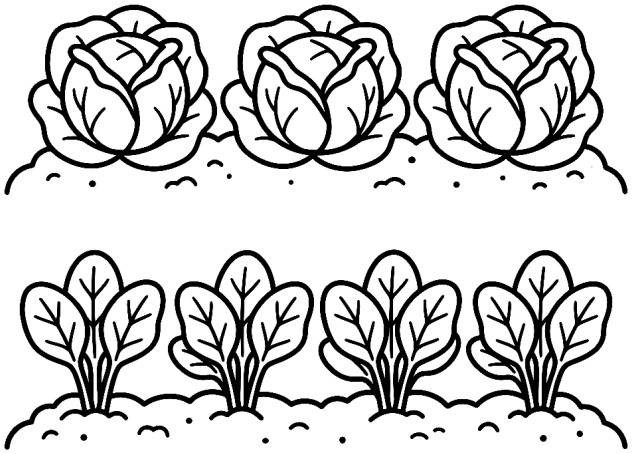
PLUM

2. Trace lowercase & write:

plum

ACT 1 BLEND WORD PRACTICE — SOUND, COLOR & TRACE

Garden Harvest (cr- & sp- Blends) • Say the blend sounds, color the picture, and trace each word!



CR- INITIAL BLEND

CROP

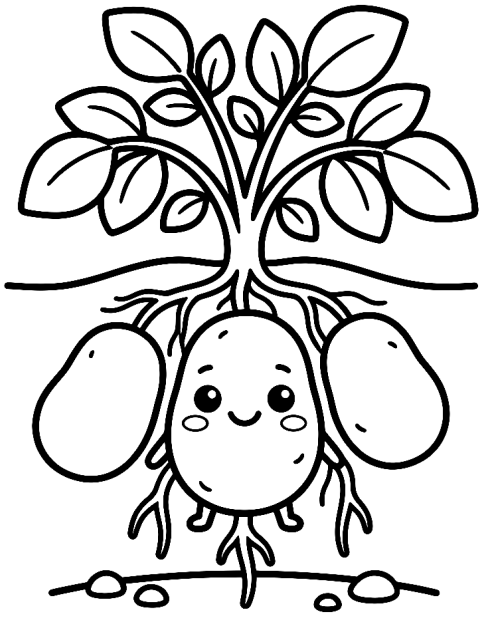
cr + op = crop

1. Trace UPPERCASE:

CROP

2. Trace lowercase & write:

crop



SP- INITIAL BLEND

SPUD

sp + ud = spud

1. Trace UPPERCASE:

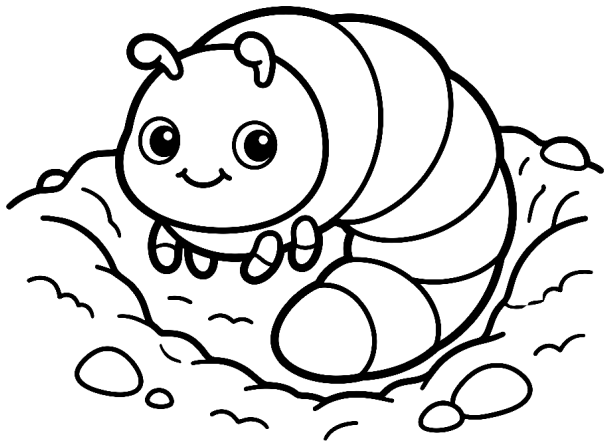
SPUD

2. Trace lowercase & write:

spud

ACT 1 BLEND WORD PRACTICE — SOUND, COLOR & TRACE

Garden Surprises (gr- & sn- Blends) • Say the blend sounds, color the picture, and trace each word!



GR- INITIAL BLEND

GRUB

gr + ub = grub

1. Trace UPPERCASE:

GRUB

2. Trace lowercase & write:

grub



SN- INITIAL BLEND

SNAG

sn + ag = snag

1. Trace UPPERCASE:

SNAG

2. Trace lowercase & write:

snag

IN THE GARDEN — BLEND WORD FIND

Look Across (→) and Down (↓) to find all 6 Garden Blend Words!

S	V	Q	G	T	H	J	P
N	W	Z	G	P	S	K	O
A	C	I	G	L	P	F	C
G	R	U	B	U	U	O	Y
R	L	G	P	M	D	Z	K
H	U	Z	M	N	G	C	N
O	J	C	R	O	P	G	D
U	T	C	L	E	M	V	K

BLEND WORD BANK — CHECK OFF EACH WORD AS YOU FIND IT!

- ☐ CLEM
- ☐ PLUM
- ☐ CROP
- ☐ SPUD
- ☐ GRUB
- ☐ SNAG

ACT 1 CONCLUSION — GOODBYE GARDEN, OFF TO THE WOODS!

You learned 6 blend words: Clem • Plum • crop • spud • grub • snag



Clem tugged his sleeve free from the **snag** and laughed. “Bye-bye, garden **crop**, **spuds**, and little **grub** — into the woods we go!”